

Student Government Association Bylaws

Addendum I – Relations

To promote sustained engagement between students, alumni, trustees, private partners, and external civic stakeholders, the Student Government Association (SGA) establishes this Addendum to define the mission, scope, structure, and responsibilities of the Relations Division. This Addendum codifies the nonpartisan duties of the Vice President of Relations (VPR), Assistant Vice President of Relations (AVPR), and the reporting roles in Alumni Relations, Trustee Relations, Civic Relations, and Private Relations, to align work with the broader objectives of the SGA.

Article I. Mission and Scope

1.1 Mission

The mission of the Relations Division is to serve as a nonpartisan liaison between the SGA and alumni, private partners, trustees, external civic and community stakeholders. The Division advances the SGA's strategic goals through student civic engagement, structured Young Alumni Trustee relations, and student–alumni interaction.

1.2 Scope

The scope of the Relations Division includes, but is not limited to:

- Alumni Relations: coordination with the Stevens Alumni Association (SAA), University Advancement, and the Student–Alumni Council (SAC) to foster sustained alumni–student engagement.
- Trustee Relations: nonpartisan, structured engagement with Young Alumni Trustees (YATs).
- Civic Relations: nonpartisan engagement with government and community stakeholders, in coordination with the Government and Community Relations Chair (GCRC) as defined in Section 7.7 of the SGA Bylaws.
- Private Partnerships: shall include, but not be limited to, nonpartisan engagement with corporate, nonprofit, and community partners, to advance SGA initiatives and student opportunities in coordination with the Government and Community Relations Chair (GCRC) as defined in Section 7.7 of the SGA Bylaws. The relations division and its members are not permitted in any way to engage with advocacy or other partisan organizations.

Article II. Structure of the Relations Division

2.1 Composition

The Relations Division shall include:

- The Vice President of Relations (VPR)

- The Assistant Vice President of Relations (AVPR)
- The Student–Alumni Council President (SAC President)
- The Government and Community Relations Chair (GCRC), as established in Section 7.7 of the SGA Bylaws

2.2 Vice President of Relations (VPR)

(a) Role

The VPR shall oversee the Relations Division, set nonpartisan strategic objectives, coordinate among reporting roles, and serve as the primary liaison from the SGA to the SAA, University Advancement, YATs, external civic stakeholders, and private partners, consistent with SGA governing documents as defined in the SGA constitution.

(b) Responsibilities

- Act as the liaison between alumni, private partners, and the SGA.
- Oversee the activities of all standing and ad hoc committees tasked with improving alumni and private relations.
- Be, or seek election to be, a Student Leader Representative on the Stevens Alumni Association Board of Directors.
- Maintain an active relationship with all Young Alumni Trustees.
- Oversee the SGA's gift account in line with Article VIII of this addendum and fundraising activities in consultation with the Vice President of Finance (VPF), and aid Recognized Student Organizations (RSOs) in establishing and stewarding their respective gift accounts.
- Ensure coordination across Alumni Relations, Trustee Relations, and Civic Relations and maintain nonpartisan standards in Civic Relations in line with this addendum's scope.
- Delegate tasks to, and coordinate with, the AVPR, SAC President, and GCRC as appropriate.

2.3 Assistant Vice President of Relations (AVPR)

(a) Appointment and Term

- Appointed by the VPR.
- Confirmed by a two thirds vote of the Senate.
- Serves a one-year term concurrent with the Cabinet term; may be reappointed.

(b) Eligibility

- The AVPR may not be a Senator and cannot hold other roles consistent with SGA governing documents.
- Must maintain nonpartisanship as defined in the scope of this addendum.

(c) Responsibilities

- Serve as the primary operational point of contact for alumni seeking to engage with the student body unless otherwise delegated by the VPR.
- Lead alumni–student engagement in close partnership with the SAC president, planning high-impact events, building mentorship pipelines, expanding student–alumni programming, and driving sustained participation.
- Perform additional nonpartisan duties for the VPR as delegated and ensure that all SGA-related activities are approved by and involve the VPR.

2.4 Student–Alumni Council (SAC) and SAC President

(a) Purpose

SAC shall function as a student organization that bridges University Advancement, the SAA, and the student body to promote student–alumni connection.

(b) Leadership

The SAC President shall be jointly selected by the VPR and the SAC Advisor from University Advancement. The SAC President shall coordinate between SGA and Advancement to align SAC initiatives with university and SGA goals.

(c) Operational Alignment

SAC shall operate primarily within the Relations Division and the SGA for events and programming while coordinating with Advancement to ensure continuity.

2.5 Government and Community Relations Chair (GCRC)

(a) Authority and Reference

The GCRC is established and governed by Section 7.7 of the SGA Bylaws. Nothing in this Addendum shall alter the authority, appointment, or scope of the GCRC as defined therein.

(b) Coordination with VPR

The GCRC shall inform the VPR to ensure strategic alignment of civic engagement activities with the Relations Division’s goals, consistent with Article V.

Article III. Alumni Relations

3.1 Advisory Role to SAA and Advancement

The SGA, through the Relations Division and in coordination with the SAA and University Advancement, shall act in an advisory and facilitative capacity to promote meaningful alumni–student engagement.

3.2 AVPR and SAC President Collaboration

- The AVPR and SAC President shall jointly curate and execute initiatives that strengthen the student–alumni pipeline, expand mentorship opportunities, and cultivate lasting alumni relationships.
- Programming may include networking, mentoring, career and affinity engagement, and collaboration with alumni chapters.

Article IV. Trustee Relations

4.1 Definitions

For purposes of this Addendum, Young Alumni Trustees (YATs) are trustees designated by the university to represent recent alumni on the Board of Trustees.

4.2 Structured Engagement with YATs

- The Relations Division shall convene at least one formal meeting each academic semester with YATs to exchange updates, discuss priorities, and identify opportunities for collaboration.
- The VPR shall coordinate agendas and ensure consistent follow-up communications.

4.3 Ongoing Communication and Presentations to the Board

- The Relations Division shall maintain a recurring communication cycle with YATs, including follow-up on action items from semesterly meetings.
- If invited by the Board of Trustees, the SGA shall deliver a formal, nonpartisan, presentation to the Board to present priorities, initiatives, and outcomes.

Article V. Civic Relations

5.1 Nonpartisan Engagement and Oversight

- The VPR and GCRC shall jointly oversee all SGA external nonpartisan political activities and the SGA’s external civic engagement strategy.
- The GCRC serves as the Senate’s designated lead for nonpartisan advocacy and direct government engagement under Section 7.7 of the SGA Bylaws.
- All newly appointed VPRs, AVPRs, and GCRCs must meet with the Office of General Counsel in their first semester to review rules of engagement for nonpartisan activities.
- The GCRC and VPR represent the SGA in external civic contexts. The GCRC shall be the primary student lead for interactions with government and community officials,

while the VPR ensures alignment with Relations Division through private engagement.

5.2 Inclusive Engagement

- The VPR shall ensure that the GCRC is included in meetings, communications, and events with government and community officials, unless otherwise requested by the GCRC.
- The GCRC shall maintain its status as an independent committee, but it is expected that the GCRC will collaborate with the VPR.'

5.3 Strategic Alignment and Collaboration

- The VPR retains responsibility for integrating civic relations into the overall external relations agenda, while recognizing the GCRC's scope as defined in Section 7.7.
- The VPR and GCRC shall meet regularly to plan and coordinate efforts to ensure engagement is consistent, collaborative, and representative of the student body.

5.4 Flexibility

- Nothing in this Article shall prevent the GCRC from engaging in initiatives within their defined purpose. The expectation is ongoing collaboration and mutual support rather than rigid division of responsibilities.

Article VI. Meetings, Planning, and Records

6.1 Internal Coordination

- The VPR shall convene coordination meetings at least monthly (bi-weekly preferred) among the AVPR, SAC President, and GCRC to plan, align, and review ongoing initiatives across Alumni Relations, Trustee Relations, and Civic Relations.

6.2 External Cadence

- YATs: At least one formal meeting per academic semester, with documented agendas and action items.
- Alumni Stakeholders: Regular coordination meetings with the SAA and University Advancement, scheduled by the VPR or AVPR, as appropriate.
- Civic Stakeholders: Meetings and communications led by the VPR, with the GCRC included and informed per Article V.

Article VII. Vacancies and Removal

7.1 AVPR Vacancy

- In the event of a vacancy in the AVPR position, the VPR shall appoint a replacement within thirty (30) days, subject to confirmation by a two thirds majority vote of the Senate. The appointee shall serve the remainder of the term.

7.2 SAC President Vacancy or Removal

- If a vacancy arises, the VPR and the SAC Advisor from University Advancement shall jointly select a replacement SAC President to serve the remainder of the term.
- The VPR may advise the SAC Advisor to remove the SAC President for failure to perform duties or misconduct, with notice to the Senate.

7.3 Legacy Clause

- If a vacancy arises in the Relations Division, all former members who are still enrolled students must be included in the selection process, unless they decline.
- All former VPRs and GCRCs shall be invited to all external, alumni, or civic, events and engagements unless they decline.

Article VIII. Gift Account

All Gift Account funds must be used for nonpartisan activities to support alumni or civic engagement efforts. Any disbursement of funds must have the approval of all current and past fundraising agents to ensure continuity of their fundraised purpose.

Article VIII. Interpretation and Conflicts

8.1 Consistency

This Addendum shall be interpreted in harmony with the SGA Constitution and Bylaws.

8.2 References

References to external stakeholders (including the SAA, University Advancement, YATs, the Board of Trustees, and the Vice President of Student Affairs) reflect institutional roles and processes as recognized by Stevens Institute of Technology and are subject to institutional change.